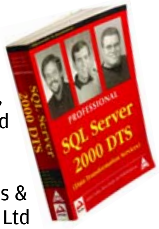
DigiPick of the month

"Burning the Midnight Coil"

This month's winner is
Dr Ranjan Sengupta
c/o Mr Balai Sarkar
Pioneer Park
Barasat, Kolkata 700124
West Bengal, India

He wins
Professional SQL Server 2000DTS
by **Mark Chaffin, Brian Knight** and **Robinson**
Published by
Shroff Publishers & Distributors Pvt Ltd



WIN!
Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **'DigiPick'** and your postal address **on or before 15th of this month** to **digipick@thinkdigit.com.** One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

game? Or, when speeding along a highway in a racing game, would you notice an ad on the side of a truck whizzing past you? The answers are 'Yes' and 'Yes', according to a recent study.

This is not exactly a revelation: the impact an ad has depends heavily on the level of involvement of the viewer. And where is the involvement and immersion greater than in games?

But it's interesting to know to what extent ads are effective in games. The study found that there's a whopping 60 per cent increase in awareness for a new product as a direct result of in-game campaigns. And interestingly, animated 3-D ads bring about twice the brand recall that static billboards do. We didn't know people were as measurable as this!

As the world gets increasingly virtual, advertising in games will, naturally become more important. "The study (proves) in-game advertising is a medium that brand managers across categories should be exploring, particularly if they want to reach the highly valuable 18 to 34-year-old male audience," said Henry Piney, MD, Europe, Nielsen Interactive Entertainment.

The study was released by Double Fusion, a provider of in-game ad services, and Nielsen Interactive Entertainment. It looked at ads within the downloadable version of London Taxi, a PC game.

REEKING OF WEALTH

Wi-Fi Is A Right!

It could happen only in America, the richest and most powerful nation ever to have existed. The mayor of San Francisco, Gavin Newsom, has declared that Wi-Fi is a "fundamental right". Something like guns. Or maybe even food.

The statement was made in the context of the city's plans for its Wi-Fi development. San Francisco wants an affordable Wi-Fi network covering all the 43 hills and the entire 49 square miles of the city.

Did we mention that Google is one of the bidders? They plan to offer it for free. The project would be funded through online advertising, a Google spokesman said.

Coming back to Newsom's statement: "This is inevitable—Wi-Fi. It is long overdue," he said. "It is to me a fundamental right to have access universally to information."

It's surprising we haven't seen much negative commentary about the statement: do San Franciscans—or Americans—actually believe something like Wi-Fi can be elevated to the level of a 'right'?

There is a redeeming aspect, though. Newsom also said that Wi-Fi was an alternative network that could kick in to provide emergency information in the event of a natural disaster. Now *there's* some method to the madness!

THE GOOD, THE BAD, ...

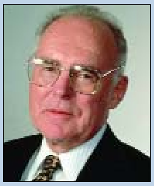
The Blooker Prize

An online self-publishing house called Lulu has announced the Blooker

People Who Changed Computing

Moore's Law

Gordon E Moore, born in 1946, in San Francisco, made the observation in 1965 that integrated circuits would double in complexity every 18 months.


Gordon E Moore

The press called this "Moore's Law," and the name has stuck since then. Moore forecast that this trend would continue through 1975. Through Intel's technology, Moore's Law has been maintained for much longer, and still holds true.

After completing a B.S. in chemistry from UC Berkeley in 1950 and a Ph.D. in chemistry and physics from Caltech in 1954, Moore started working at Shockley Semiconductor Laboratory.

He left in 1957 to launch Fairchild Semiconductor. Soon, with Moore leading the production engineering, Fairchild was shipping its first transistors.

Fairchild was a successful company, but Moore left because of management changes in its parent company. In 1968, he co-founded Intel, initially serving as executive VP, to become the president and CEO in 1975.

He led the company to produce the world's first single-chip microprocessor, and went on to become the world's largest chipmaker. In 1997, Moore was named Chairman Emeritus.

Amongst other honours, Moore received, in 1990, the National Medal of Technology from President Bush. An avid fisherman, Moore enjoys visiting fishing-related Web sites.